

Pair a compatible AI assistant with your story map to build and edit structure in real time · storymap.spertsuite.com

WHAT IS CONNECT AI?

Connect AI is a feature in SPERT® Story Map that lets a compatible AI assistant build or edit your story map in real time. When the connection is active, the AI can create themes, backbones, and rib items on your behalf — they appear on your map as the AI works. You stay in control at every step: the AI asks what you want to build before doing anything, and you choose exactly what it can access.

Connect AI works through the **MCP protocol** (Model Context Protocol) — a standard for giving AI assistants access to external tools. SPERT Story Map hosts a dedicated MCP server at mcp.spertsuite.com that the AI calls to read and write your map structure. The AI assistant must be configured to reach this server before the feature can be used.

HOW IT WORKS — EACH SESSION

#	Action	Detail
1	Open a project and click Connect AI	The Connect AI button is in the project header, next to your product name. A consent modal appears.
2	Choose permissions	Write Mode (required) — the AI can create and edit themes, backbones, and rib items. Read Mode (optional) — the AI can see your current map structure before making changes. Enable Read Mode when you want the AI to refine or add to an existing map rather than build from scratch. Click Connect .
3	Copy the pairing code and prompt	A short pairing code (e.g., CRANE-7842) appears alongside two copy buttons: Copy Code (the code alone) and Copy Prompt (a ready-to-paste message that includes the code and detailed instructions for the AI). The code expires in 15 minutes.
4	Paste the prompt into your AI assistant	Open your AI assistant — it must already be configured with the SPERT MCP server (see One-Time Setup). Paste the copied prompt and send it. The assistant will call the MCP server to claim the session, then ask you what product you are planning and which story map structure fits best before building anything.
5	Review and disconnect	Themes, backbones, and rib items appear on your map in real time. Use Ctrl+Z to undo any AI action. Toggle Read Mode on or off from the Connect AI panel at any time. Click Disconnect when you are done — or the session expires automatically after 7 days.

Note: Do not switch projects while the AI is actively building — Connect AI is scoped to the project that was open when you clicked Connect. Rib items with sprint progress already recorded cannot be resized by the AI, matching the same protection the Sizing tab enforces.

ONE-TIME SETUP: CONNECT YOUR AI CLIENT

Connect AI requires an AI client that supports MCP servers. Complete this setup once; every subsequent session starts at step 1 above. Five clients work today:

claude.ai web (Pro / Max / Team / Enterprise)	Lowest-friction path for non-developers — no terminal or config file required. Free-tier accounts are not supported. In claude.ai, go to Settings → Connectors → Add custom connector . Paste the server URL: https://mcp.spertsuite.com No API key is needed — click Save. To use it: open a new conversation, confirm the SPERT connector is active, open SPERT Story Map in your browser, click Connect AI, and paste the Copy Prompt.
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Claude Code (CLI, any plan)	Best for developers — one command. Run once in any terminal: <code>claude mcp add --transport http spert-suite https://mcp.spertsuite.com</code> Add <code>--scope user</code> to make the server available across all projects (default is project-scope only). Confirm with <code>claude mcp list</code> — you should see <code>spert-suite</code> in the output. To use it: start a Claude Code session, open SPERT Story Map, click Connect AI, and paste the Copy Prompt.
Claude Desktop (config file)	Requires Node.js (for npx). Locate the config file: on macOS, <code>~/Library/Application Support/Claude/claude_desktop_config.json</code> ; on Windows, <code>%APPDATA%\Claude\claude_desktop_config.json</code> . Add the following to the mcpServers object (create the file if it does not exist): <code>"spert-suite": { "command": "npx", "args": ["mcp-remote", "https://mcp.spertsuite.com"] }</code> Save the file and restart Claude Desktop. mcp-remote installs automatically on first run.
Grok (paid tiers)	Self-service on all paid Grok tiers — similar UX to claude.ai Connectors. Go to grok.com/connectors → New Connector → Custom → paste https://mcp.spertsuite.com . No authentication required — click Create. To use it: open a Grok conversation, open SPERT Story Map in your browser, click Connect AI, and paste the Copy Prompt.
ChatGPT (Pro / Team / Enterprise / Edu, Developer Mode)	Requires Developer Mode to be enabled. On Pro plans, go to Settings → Apps & Connectors → Advanced → Developer Mode → On . On Business / Enterprise / Edu plans, a workspace admin must enable it from Workspace Settings → Permissions & Roles → Connected Data. Once enabled, add the server: click + in a conversation → More → paste https://mcp.spertsuite.com , no authentication. To use it: open SPERT Story Map in your browser, click Connect AI, and paste the Copy Prompt into the ChatGPT conversation.

Also works — Copilot Studio (advanced): In a Copilot Studio agent, go to **Tools** → **New tool** → **Model Context Protocol**, paste <https://mcp.spertsuite.com>, set Authentication to **None**, and click Create. Use the agent's Test panel to interact. This requires a Microsoft 365 license and is higher-friction than the paths above — best suited for developers building on the Microsoft platform. Note: this connects the Copilot Studio agent, not Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat directly; deploying to Copilot Chat requires additional admin configuration.

WHAT STILL DOESN'T WORK

Connect AI requires an AI client with MCP server support configured. If you paste the Copy Prompt into an AI that has no MCP connection, the assistant reads the tool-call instructions but has no actual channel to your story map — nothing changes in the app. In some cases the AI may even fabricate a response, describing a map it claims to have built. The tell: tool names like **resolve_session_code** appear in the reply, but your map stays empty.

Not supported today: Gemini web app (gemini.google.com) — no self-service custom MCP connector in the consumer interface yet. Free-tier claude.ai accounts — Connectors require a paid plan. ChatGPT Free and Plus without Developer Mode enabled. Any other AI assistant without MCP support configured.

WHAT'S COMING

MCP adoption has moved quickly. Claude, ChatGPT, and Grok all support custom MCP connections today, and Copilot Studio works for developers building on the Microsoft platform. The notable remaining gap for consumer users is the Gemini web app — Google's Gemini CLI works for developers via a config file (similar to Claude Code), but there is no self-service custom MCP connector in the consumer Gemini web interface yet.

As MCP adoption continues to expand, Connect AI will work with new clients automatically — no changes to the SPERT server or your workflow will be required. The same pairing-code workflow works across all supported clients today.

WRITE MODE, READ MODE & PRIVACY

Write Mode (required)	Lets the AI create themes, backbones, and rib items in the open project. The AI cannot delete items, move cards between releases, or modify progress data. Rib items with sprint progress already recorded are size-protected — the AI cannot change their t-shirt size, matching the same lock the Sizing tab enforces.
Read Mode (optional)	Shares a compact snapshot of your current map with the AI — theme names, backbone names, and rib item names only. No progress data, allocation details, assessment notes, or rib item notes are included. Enable Read Mode when asking the AI to refine or extend an existing map; leave it off when building from scratch. Toggle at any time from the Connect AI session panel.
Session data & expiry	Pairing codes are single-use and expire after 15 minutes. Session data (the ops queue and any Read Mode snapshot) is stored in Firebase and auto-purged after 7 days. Click Disconnect to end a session and delete the snapshot immediately. Full details at spertsuite.com/ai-privacy .
AI-built map limits	A single Connect AI session can build up to 5 themes, 10 backbones per theme, and 10 rib items per backbone — up to 500 rib items total. These limits apply only to AI-assisted building; the standard app has no structural size limits. Existing maps and all other editing tools are otherwise unchanged.
Tips & caveats	Enable Read Mode before asking the AI to edit an existing map — without it, the AI cannot see your current structure and may duplicate work. Undo (Ctrl+Z) works on all AI-generated content. Review the AI's output before saving a JSON backup, as Undo history resets on page refresh. Don't switch projects mid-session; Connect AI is scoped to the project open at the time you clicked Connect.